

D443

Health Assessment

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 52-year-old electrician who drove himself to the clinic in the rain says, “My chest feels tight when I climb stairs.” His blood pressure is 148/92. Which part of this information is subjective data?

- A. That he is 52 and an electrician
- B. His blood pressure of 148/92
- C. That he drove in the rain
- D. The statement that his chest feels tight on stairs

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which finding is objective data?

- A. The patient says she feels dizzy
- B. The patient describes nausea after meals
- C. Respiratory rate of 24 breaths per minute
- D. The patient rates pain 7 out of 10

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A nurse is examining the abdomen of a patient, a college student who works at a coffee shop, admitted for vague stomach pain. She has just finished inspection. The patient ate two hours ago. What should the nurse do next?

- A. Auscultate bowel sounds
- B. Wait an hour, since the patient ate recently
- C. Palpate for tenderness
- D. Percuss for tympany

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Why does the nurse listen to the abdomen before palpating it?

- A.** Bowel sounds are always absent after palpation.
- B.** Palpation and percussion can change bowel sounds.
- C.** Auscultation comes last in every body system.
- D.** Palpation is less important in the abdomen.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

Twenty minutes after extubation, a patient who is a high-school band director has a high-pitched crowing sound on inspiration that the nurse can hear from the doorway. The room is noisy with visitors. Which sound is this, and what does it mean?

- A.** Stridor, an upper-airway emergency
- B.** Wheezing from asthma
- C.** Fine crackles from fluid
- D.** A normal sound after a breathing tube is removed

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Fine crackles are heard at both lung bases at the end of inspiration. Which condition fits best?

- A.** Heart failure with fluid in the lungs
- B.** Upper-airway blockage from swelling
- C.** Healthy lungs
- D.** An asthma attack

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A nursing student practicing on a classmate who runs cross-country wants to hear S1 at its loudest. The classmate's heart rate is 58. Where should she place the stethoscope?

- A.** Anywhere; S1 is equally loud everywhere
- B.** Over the aortic area, because S1 is aortic valve closure
- C.** At the apex (fifth intercostal space, midclavicular line)
- D.** At the base (second intercostal space)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

After a fall at the bus stop where he waits each morning, a patient who works as a tailor opens his eyes when spoken to, is confused about the date, and localizes to pain. What is his Glasgow Coma Scale score?

- A. 11
- B. 15
- C. 12
- D. 13

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A patient has a GCS of 8. Eyes open to pain (2) and the patient withdraws from pain (4). What is the verbal score?

- A. 6
- B. 1 (none)
- C. 4 (confused)
- D. 2 (incomprehensible sounds)

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

10.

A 38-year-old lifeguard who uses sunscreen most days shows the nurse a 4 mm mole on her back. It has an irregular border and several shades of brown and black. Her sister had a benign cyst removed last year. What is the best interpretation?

- A. Benign, because it is under 6 mm.
- B. Concerning, and it should be referred for evaluation.
- C. Benign, because she uses sunscreen.
- D. Concerning only if all five ABCDE features are present.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

11.

A 6-month-old who has had diarrhea for two days and attends a home daycare is brought to the clinic. His older brother had the same illness last week. The nurse notes a sunken anterior fontanel. What does this finding suggest?

- A.** Early closure of the fontanel
- B.** A normal finding for his age
- C.** Increased intracranial pressure
- D.** Dehydration

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

A patient recovering from a stroke, whose grandson visits after school, can lift her right arm off the bed against gravity but cannot hold it up against any pressure from the nurse. Her left arm is 5/5. How should the right arm be graded?

- A.** 4/5
- B.** 3/5
- C.** 5/5
- D.** 2/5

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A 52-year-old electrician ~~who drove himself to the clinic in the rain~~ says, "My chest feels tight when I climb stairs." His blood pressure is 148/92. Which part of this information is subjective data?

Target word: subjective item **Decides:** Subjective = what the patient reports feeling.

A	Adjacent category	Demographic data is part of the history, not a symptom report.
B	Inverted operation	A measured value is objective.
C	Camouflage	A background detail, not the data being classified.
D	Correct	It is his own report of a sensation.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Which finding is objective data?

Target word: reverse: find the objective item **Decides:** Objective = observed or measured.

A	Inverted operation	A reported feeling is subjective.
B	Adjacent category	A symptom history, which is subjective.
C	Correct	Measured by the nurse.
D	Confusion set	A number, but it is still the patient's report.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A nurse is examining the abdomen of a patient, ~~a college student who works at a coffee shop~~, admitted for vague stomach pain. She has just finished inspection. ~~The patient ate two hours ago.~~ What should the nurse do next?

Target word: next step after inspection **Decides:** Abdomen: inspect, auscultate, percuss, palpate.

A	Correct	Listening comes before touch so palpation does not change bowel sounds.
B	Camouflage	Recent eating does not change the sequence.
C	Confusion set	Uses the order for other body systems.
D	Dropped element	Skips auscultation.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

Why does the nurse listen to the abdomen before palpating it?

Target word: reverse: the reason for the order **Decides:** Touch can stimulate or change bowel sounds.

A	Absolute language	Palpation may change them, not always erase them.
B	Correct	Auscultating first gives an accurate baseline.
C	Inverted operation	It comes last elsewhere; in the abdomen it comes second.
D	Adjacent category	Palpation matters; the issue is order, not value.

5. Answer A Concept 3

Twenty minutes after extubation, a patient ~~who is a high school band director~~ has a high-pitched crowing sound on inspiration that the nurse can hear from the doorway. ~~The room is noisy with visitors.~~ Which sound is this, and what does it mean?

Target word: identify sound and urgency **Decides:** Loud inspiratory crowing = stridor = upper-airway narrowing.

A	Correct	Stridor after extubation suggests laryngeal swelling and needs immediate action.
B	Confusion set	Wheezes come from lower airways and are usually heard on expiration.
C	Adjacent category	Crackles are soft popping sounds, not crowing.
D	Absolute language	Stridor is never an expected finding.

6. Answer A Concept 3 • transfer

Fine crackles are heard at both lung bases at the end of inspiration. Which condition fits best?

Target word: reverse: from sound to cause **Decides:** Fine crackles = fluid in small airways.

A	Correct	Fluid in alveoli causes fine crackles at the bases.
B	Adjacent category	That produces stridor.
C	Inverted operation	Crackles are an abnormal finding.
D	Confusion set	Asthma produces wheezes.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A nursing student practicing on a classmate ~~who runs cross-country~~ wants to hear S1 at its loudest. ~~The classmate's heart rate is 58.~~ Where should she place the stethoscope?

Target word: S1 location **Decides:** S1 is AV-valve closure, loudest at the apex.

A	Absolute language	Its loudness depends on location.
B	Confusion set	Aortic valve closure produces S2.
C	Correct	Mitral and tricuspid closure is loudest near the apex.
D	Inverted operation	That is where S2 is loudest.

8. Answer C Concept 5

After a fall ~~at the bus stop where he waits each morning,~~ a patient ~~who works as a tailor~~ opens his eyes when spoken to, is confused about the date, and localizes to pain. What is his Glasgow Coma Scale score?

Target word: GCS total **Decides:** Eyes to voice 3 + confused 4 + localizes 5.

A	Wrong stem number	Gives confused speech 3 points instead of 4.
B	Absolute language	Full score requires spontaneous eyes, orientation, and obeying commands.
C	Correct	3 + 4 + 5 = 12.
D	Confusion set	Gives localizing 6 points, which is the score for obeying commands.

9. Answer D Concept 5 · transfer

A patient has a GCS of 8. Eyes open to pain (2) and the patient withdraws from pain (4). What is the verbal score?

Target word: solve for the missing component **Decides:** $8 - 2 - 4$.

A	Inverted operation	Adds instead of subtracting the known parts.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out one of the known components.
C	Wrong stem number	Copies the motor score.
D	Correct	$8 - 2 - 4 = 2$.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A 38-year-old lifeguard ~~who uses sunscreen most days~~ shows the nurse a 4 mm mole on her back. It has an irregular border and several shades of brown and black. ~~Her sister had a benign cyst removed last year.~~ What is the best interpretation?

Target word: concern level **Decides:** Irregular border and color variation meet ABCDE criteria.

A	Dropped element	Diameter is one criterion; others are already present.
B	Correct	Border and color findings raise concern regardless of size.
C	Camouflage	Sunscreen use does not change what the lesion looks like.
D	Absolute language	Any one feature justifies referral.

11. Answer D Concept 7

A 6-month-old who has had diarrhea for two days ~~and attends a home daycare~~ is brought to the clinic. ~~His older brother had the same illness last week.~~ The nurse notes a sunken anterior fontanel. What does this finding suggest?

Target word: meaning of sunken fontanel **Decides:** Sunken = fluid loss.

A	Confusion set	Closure is a different finding from a sunken soft spot.
B	Adjacent category	The anterior fontanel is expected to be open, but it should be flat, not sunken.
C	Inverted operation	That causes a bulging fontanel.
D	Correct	A sunken fontanel reflects low fluid volume.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A patient recovering from a stroke, ~~whose grandson visits after school,~~ can lift her right arm off the bed against gravity but cannot hold it up against any pressure from the nurse. ~~Her left arm is 5/5.~~ How should the right arm be graded?

Target word: strength grade **Decides:** Against gravity, no resistance = 3.

A	Adjacent category	Grade 4 needs some resistance.
B	Correct	Full movement against gravity without resistance is grade 3.
C	Camouflage	Copies the left-arm grade.
D	Inverted operation	Grade 2 is movement only with gravity removed.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Subjective vs. objective data	Subjective data is what the patient says or feels; objective data is what the nurse observes, measures, or tests.	Calling anything written in the chart objective, even a patient's quoted complaint.	Quotation marks or "the patient reports" versus a measured value.
2	Abdominal exam sequence	Inspect, auscultate, percuss, then palpate, because touching the abdomen first can change bowel sounds.	Using the head-to-toe order of inspect, palpate, percuss, auscultate for the abdomen.	"Which step comes next?" during an abdominal exam.
3	Adventitious lung sounds	Fine crackles suggest fluid in small airways (pneumonia, heart failure); wheezes mean narrowed airways (asthma); stridor is upper-airway blockage and an emergency.	Treating every added sound the same or calling stridor a wheeze.	A described sound: popping, whistling, crowing, and where or when it is heard.
4	Heart sounds	S1 is closure of the mitral and tricuspid valves, loudest at the apex; S2 is closure of the aortic and pulmonic valves, loudest at the base.	Swapping which valves make S1 and S2 or where each is loudest.	A stethoscope location or valve name next to S1 or S2.
5	Glasgow Coma Scale	GCS = eye (1-4) + verbal (1-5) + motor (1-6); total 3-15, and 8 or below signals severe impairment.	Using the wrong point range for a category, or treating any score as "normal" without adding.	Descriptions of eye opening, speech, and movement.
6	Skin lesion ABCDEs	Asymmetry, Border irregularity, Color variation, Diameter over 6 mm, and Evolving change each raise concern for melanoma; one feature is enough to refer.	Dismissing a lesion because it is small.	A mole described by shape, border, color, size, or change.
7	Infant fontanel	The posterior fontanel closes by about 2 months and the anterior by 12-18 months; a sunken fontanel suggests dehydration and a bulging one suggests raised pressure.	Mixing up sunken and bulging, or calling an open anterior fontanel abnormal in a young infant.	An infant's age and a description of the soft spot.
8	Muscle strength grading	0 = no contraction, 1 = trace, 2 = movement with gravity removed, 3 = against gravity only, 4 = against some resistance, 5 = full strength.	Grading movement against gravity as 4 or grading 2 and 3 backwards.	A description of what the patient can move against.

Course scope (public description): The Health Assessment course focuses on concepts and skills necessary to collect a comprehensive health history and perform a head-to-toe and focused assessments on diverse patients across the lifespan. The emphasis will be to differentiate between normal and abnormal findings of various body systems such as the following: integumentary, head & neck, eyes & ears, respiratory, cardiovascular, gastrointestinal, renal, musculoskeletal, nervous, and reproductive systems. Corequisites are D442 and D444.